

RJ GROUP

HUMAN RESOURCES POLICY MANUAL

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Only

Document Control

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Governance & Administration

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SECTION 1 – INTRODUCTION

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this Human Resources Policy Manual (hereinafter referred to as the "Manual" or "Handbook") is to establish a comprehensive, transparent, and uniform framework for the administration of personnel policies, practices, and benefits within RJ Group. This document serves as the single source of truth for employment guidelines, corporate governance, operational workflows, and legal compliance. It is designed to foster a professional, high-performance, inclusive, and equitable working environment where employee rights are balanced with organizational standards and delivery accountability.

1.2 Scope

This Manual governs all employment lifecycle events and professional conducts within RJ Group. It encompasses operational regulations, statutory frameworks, information security mandates, ethical expectations, and comprehensive guidelines on compensation, benefits, and separations. This Manual supersedes all prior verbal agreements, policy outlines, custom arrangements, or localized practices previously executed by any department or supervisor, establishing a standard baseline across all business units and operational regions within India.

1.3 Applicability

This Manual applies unconditionally to all employees of RJ Group across India, including permanent employees, probationary team members, contract personnel, retainers, consultants, interns, and trainees. All personnel are bound by the regulations contained herein, whether operating directly from a physical company office, working in a hybrid arrangement, or stationed at a client facility. Compliance with this Manual is a mandatory condition of initial and continuing employment with RJ Group.

1.4 Definitions

- **Company:** Refers to RJ Group, its subsidiaries, affiliates, and regional offices across India.
- **Employee:** Any individual who is engaged by the Company for wages, salary, or stipend to perform technical, administrative, executive, or management functions, whose terms are explicitly governed by an execution contract or employment letter.
- **Management:** Refers to the Executive Leadership Team, Board of Directors, Chief Human Resources Officer, and designated Functional Heads of RJ Group.
- **HRMS:** Human Resources Management System—the enterprise digital platform utilized for tracking attendance, leaves, payroll, appraisals, asset records, and lifecycle changes.

- **Hybrid Model:** A structured working system combining physical office presence with secure remote work, subject to direct management approval and production schedules.

1.5 Policy Governance

The Corporate HR Department is the exclusive custodian of this Manual. The Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) is authorized to interpret, clarify, and issue operational circulars regarding the execution of these policies. The Management reserves the absolute right to amend, alter, delete, append, or suspend any provision of this Manual at its discretion to align with market dynamics, financial conditions, or shifting regulatory mandates. Amendments become binding upon formal deployment via the corporate intranet or HRMS portal.

1.6 Employee Responsibilities

Every employee is legally obligated to read, understand, and comply fully with all sections of this Manual. Lack of explicit awareness of any policy or rule will never be accepted as an excuse or mitigating factor in cases of non-compliance, performance failure, or disciplinary infractions. Employees must attest to their compliance annually through the HRMS platform via digital acknowledgment. Any variance discovered between daily conduct and these rules must be instantly reported to Corporate HR.

SECTION 2 – COMPANY OVERVIEW

2.1 Company Background

RJ Group is an agile, enterprise-grade IT and Software Services enterprise founded on the principles of engineering excellence, customer-centric solutioning, and technological innovation. Catering to a diverse global clientele across North America, Europe, Asia-Pacific, and domestic markets, RJ Group specializes in full-stack cloud computing, application modernization, predictive data analytics, artificial intelligence implementation, and robust cybersecurity engineering. With an expanding talent base of 200 to 1000 highly specialized engineers, the firm provides end-to-end digital transformation pipelines to Fortune 500 companies and high-growth mid-market organizations alike.

2.2 Vision

To emerge as a premier global hub for transformative digital engineering, enabling businesses to navigate complex systemic disruptions through hyper-scalable, secure, and resilient software ecosystems, driven by a deeply empowered workforce.

2.3 Mission

To deliver superior commercial value to our enterprise clients through elite technological architectures and robust project management methodologies, while fostering an organizational climate that accelerates personal technical brilliance, absolute professional integrity, and sustainable corporate citizenship.

2.4 Core Values

- **Innovation First:** Rejecting incremental stagnation in favor of cutting-edge tech integration and continuous architectural exploration.
- **Absolute Integrity:** Total transparency in code, billing, metrics, internal relations, client disclosures, and compliance obligations.
- **Customer Obsession:** Aligning software design, service-level delivery metrics, and architectural outcomes perfectly with our customers' long-term business trajectories.
- **Radical Meritocracy:** Designing an organizational structure where career progression, financial incentives, and leadership assignments are driven exclusively by objective performance metrics, cultural alignment, and documented capability metrics.

2.5 Expected Behaviors

Employees are expected to exhibit proactive accountability, meticulous engineering standards, punctuality in delivery commitments, transparent collaborative communication, and an unyielding commitment to security. Respectful peer interactions across diverse hierarchies, complete rejection of office politics, and an eagerness to upscale competencies during technological paradigm shifts form the fundamental behavioral baseline of our teams.

2.6 Organizational Culture

The cultural framework at RJ Group blends structural discipline with engineering autonomy. We promote an open-door operational layout where architectural concepts are debated strictly on data merits, and technical contribution takes precedence over formal designation titles. We are dedicated to providing psychological safety, work-life equilibrium through managed hybrid structures, and a strict baseline of mutual dignity, ensuring an environment free from toxicity or systemic prejudice.

SECTION 3 – EMPLOYMENT FRAMEWORK

3.1 Employment Categories

To maintain systemic clarity and optimize resource allocation across extensive software delivery portfolios, RJ Group categorizes its workforce based on operational tenure, contractual scope, and organizational objectives. These classifications determine the distribution of corporate benefits, payroll schedules, leaves, and legal structures.

3.2 Permanent Employees

Permanent employees are full-time personnel who have successfully completed their designated probationary window, received a formal confirmation letter from Corporate HR, and are retained on an ongoing basis subject to sustained performance levels and compliance tracking. These employees qualify for the complete basket of statutory benefits, medical coverage, leaves, and long-term appraisal structures.

3.3 Probationary Employees

All newly recruited individuals enter the company under standard probationary status for a fixed duration of six (6) months from their official joining date. This phase allows for real-time assessment of technical capabilities, cultural fit, operational attendance patterns, and execution capability. This window may be extended or shortened at the sole discretion of the Unit Head and HR based on performance evaluations.

3.4 Contract Employees

Contract employees are individuals onboarded for fixed-duration projects, technical spikes, or specialized client assignments. Their employment terms are governed exclusively by their specific independent contracting agreements, and they are not entitled to standard permanent employee benefit structures, leaves, or long-term performance frameworks unless explicitly written into their contracts.

3.5 Interns

Interns are students or recent graduates onboarded to undergo practical technical training and corporate exposure for a duration ranging between two (2) and twelve (12) months. Internships are structured learning trajectories monitored by assigned delivery mentors. Interns receive a predefined monthly stipend, are bound by standard non-disclosure terms, and are eligible for performance-based conversion to permanent staff at the close of their tenure.

3.6 Consultants

Consultants are senior subject-matter experts, domain advisors, or technical architects retained on specialized service-fee models to direct strategic programs, audit delivery pipelines, or execute niche client engagements. They operate under a defined statement of work (SOW) and do not fall within standard payroll or HR lifecycle benefit categories.

3.7 Employment Documentation

Every employee must execute a formal, legally enforceable Employment Agreement prior to or on their official joining date. This contract contains precise details on designation, base compensation, variable benefits, non-disclosure terms, intellectual property assignment, compliance rules, and severance mandates. No employee may commence client-facing work or access corporate repositories without this documentation being completed.

3.8 Employment Verification

All employment offers are strictly contingent upon the absolute verification of candidate credentials, including educational records, prior employment track record, criminal history clearances, and reference checks. Discovery of any falsified documentation, material omissions, or misrepresentations during or after onboarding results in instant termination under major misconduct terms, with forfeiture of all outstanding dues.

SECTION 4 – RECRUITMENT POLICY

4.1 Workforce Planning

Workforce planning at RJ Group operates on a quarterly review cycle. Business Unit Heads, Delivery Managers, and Talent Acquisition (TA) leads collaborate to project talent gaps, project pipelines, tech stack requirements, and revenue targets. No recruitment cycle may initiate without a formal, digitally signed Resource Requisition Form (RRF) routed through the HRMS, containing authorized budget and technical band mappings.

4.2 Recruitment Process

The Talent Acquisition team leverages multiple authorized pipelines including direct applications, job boards, professional networks, employee referrals, and empaneled third-party executive search agencies. The standard workflow mandates structured progression from sourcing to screening, automated assessment, multiple deep-dive technical panels, a cultural evaluation, and an HR compensation review, ensuring a highly objective hiring standard.

4.3 Candidate Screening

Sourced profiles are meticulously parsed against standard job descriptions, required tech stacks, educational thresholds, and mandatory experience bands. Preliminary telephonic or digital screening is executed by the TA team to gauge raw communication alignment, immediate cultural fit, compensation matching, notice period feasibility, and basic functional competencies before routing profiles to technical panels.

4.4 Technical Assessments

Candidates for engineering and technical roles are required to undergo standard automated coding challenges, architectural design assessments, or case-study submissions hosted on secure enterprise platforms. These assessments test algorithm efficiency, structural optimization, debugging velocity, clean code compliance, and problem-solving methodologies under rigid timing limits.

4.5 Interview Process

The interview structure comprises:

- **Technical Round 1:** Core functional capabilities, code parsing, data structures, and tech stack deep dive.
- **Technical Round 2 / Architectural Round:** Systems architecture, scalability design, cloud patterns, and past project execution deep dives.
- **Management / Cultural Round:** Evaluating agile understanding, team collaboration, delivery resilience, conflict management, and ethical alignment.
- **HR Round:** Structural negotiation, compensation structuring, reference cross-checks, and policy alignment briefing.

4.6 Reference Checks

Prior to finalizing any corporate offer, the TA team mandates at least two (2) professional references from previous employers, ideally including a direct reporting manager or tech lead. These checks seek to confirm performance consistency, integrity indicators, collaboration metrics, and real reasons for exit.

4.7 Background Verification (BGV)

RJ Group partners with authorized third-party verification agencies to execute an exhaustive background verification. This includes authentication of standard educational degrees, previous employment tenures, last drawn compensation slips, permanent and current residential addresses, identity credentials (PAN, Aadhaar), and a clean criminal record check via court registry checks. A "Red" or failed BGV report is ground for immediate offer revocation or termination.

4.8 Offer Management

Upon clearing all verification checks and internal approval routings, a formal Offer Letter is generated via the HRMS. The offer outlines the Annual Gross CTC, detailed component breakouts, proposed joining date, location, probation terms, and conditions of acceptance. Offers remain valid for a strict window of three (3) business days from transmission, after which they automatically expire unless written extensions are granted by the TA Head.

4.9 Joining Requirements

On the scheduled joining date, the candidate must submit physical or verified digital copies of their educational certificates, relieving letters and experience certificates from all prior employers, past 3 months' pay slips, Form 16, identity proofs, and passport photographs. Failure to submit these mandatory documents on Day 1 will delay onboarding and payroll initialization.

SECTION 5 – ONBOARDING POLICY

5.1 Pre-Joining Activities

To ensure a flawless transition, the Employee Experience team initiates pre-joining engagement five (5) days prior to onboarding. This includes gathering digital asset choices, initiating basic HRMS portal profiles, coordinating with the IT infrastructure team for email provisioning, and providing the candidate with an agenda for their initial week.

5.2 First Day Orientation

Day 1 orientation is a mandatory structured program managed by HR. It covers a comprehensive overview of RJ Group's history, business divisions, delivery structures, corporate leadership, HR policies, leave systems, payroll dynamics, and performance tracking models. The day concludes with an interactive Q&A session and introduction to designated team buddies.

5.3 Documentation Requirements

During the orientation window, HR collects, checks, and archives all required statutory declarations. This includes Provident Fund declaration forms (Form 11), Gratuity nomination forms (Form F), ESIC registrations (where applicable), bank account setup instructions, IT declaration forms, and signed employee non-disclosure and intellectual property assignment agreements.

5.4 IT Asset Allocation

The IT Infrastructure Team issues personal computational hardware (laptop, charger, security tokens, peripheral accessories) based on the employee's role requirements. Every allocated asset is logged against the employee's unique ID in the HRMS asset register. The employee must execute an IT Asset Acceptance Form, acknowledging receipt and accepting full financial accountability for accidental damage or loss arising from negligence.

5.5 Security Training

Within the first forty-eight (48) hours of joining, every employee must complete the mandatory corporate Information Security & Data Privacy training module. This covers threat identification, phishing simulations, password guidelines, secure VPN mechanics, customer data compliance (GDPR/DPDP Act), and internal incident reporting. Completion of this module is required to unlock full access to client repositories.

5.6 Probation Objectives

During the initial week, the direct Reporting Manager must establish a structured 30-60-90-180 day performance plan containing explicit technical objectives, key deliverables, and training milestones. These goals are logged in the HRMS Performance module and serve as the objective framework for mid-probation checkpoints and final confirmation assessments at the six-month mark.

SECTION 6 – WORKING HOURS AND ATTENDANCE

6.1 Office Timings

The standard operating calendar for RJ Group spans from Monday through Friday. The official daily core working hours are from 09:30 AM to 06:30 PM, which includes a designated sixty (60) minute break for lunch and refreshments. All employees are expected to structure their daily operational tasks, client touchpoints, and internal scrums within this operational envelope.

6.2 Hybrid Work Expectations

RJ Group operates a disciplined hybrid engagement framework designed to optimize operational flexibility while preserving team synergy. All permanent employees are required to work from a physical RJ Group office for a minimum of three (3) mandatory days per week, with the remaining two (2) days eligible for remote work, subject to delivery milestones and direct client compliance constraints. Managers reserve the right to mandate

full 5-day physical attendance during critical production releases, client audits, or escalation management spikes.

6.3 Attendance Tracking

Daily attendance and active working hours are tracked through integrated electronic systems. Physical office presence is captured via biometric fingerprint logs or RFID card taps at office access points. Remote work attendance is verified via secure login timestamps on the corporate network and HRMS portal. To be credited with a full working day, an employee must log a minimum of eight (8) active working hours. A logged duration between four (4) and eight (8) hours is marked as a half-day. Any duration below four hours is processed as an unauthorized absence.

6.4 Late Arrivals

A grace window of fifteen (15) minutes is permitted, allowing arrivals up to 09:45 AM. Any arrival recorded after 09:45 AM is classified as a late arrival. Every third (3rd) instance of a late arrival within a calendar month will trigger an automatic deduction of one-half (0.5) day of Casual Leave. Consistent tardiness exceeding four instances in a quarter will prompt formal disciplinary escalation by HR.

6.5 Absenteeism

Any absence from scheduled work without a prior approved leave request on the HRMS is classified as an unauthorized absence. Employees must notify their direct manager via email or corporate chat by 10:00 AM on the day of occurrence if an emergency prevents them from logging in. Unauthorized absence extending beyond three (3) consecutive business days is classified as absconding, triggering immediate suspension of corporate system access and initialization of disciplinary actions.

6.6 Shift Operations

To ensure 24/7 client delivery continuity across global time zones, certain business units operate under structural shifts (e.g., Afternoon Shift: 02:00 PM to 11:00 PM; Night Shift: 09:30 PM to 06:30 AM). Shift allocations are governed by Project Managers and must be updated in the HRMS roster weekly. Employees deployed in designated shifts are entitled to corporate shift allowances as defined by compensation frameworks.

6.7 Timesheet Policy

All technical personnel must log their daily work allocation against specific project codes, task nodes, or client tickets via the corporate project tracking engine. Timesheets must be finalized and submitted for manager approval by 06:00 PM every Friday. Accurate timesheet maintenance is vital for accurate client billing, project costing, and utilization analysis. Delayed or falsified timesheet logging will result in holdovers on monthly payroll release.

6.8 Overtime Guidelines

As a professional IT services company, employees in managerial, specialized engineering, or supervisory tracks do not qualify for hourly overtime wages. In instances where exceptional critical system breakdowns, platform migrations, or production outages require prolonged weekend support, employees may claim a Compensatory Off (Comp-Off) in alignment with the guidelines defined in Section 7 of this Manual, subject to prior written approval from the Delivery Head.

Operational Example – Attendance Miscalculation: An engineer logs in at 10:15 AM (late arrival) and logs out at 05:45 PM. The total tracked time equals 6.5 hours. Because this falls beneath the mandatory 8-hour requirement for a full day, the HRMS automatically records this as a Half-Day absence, resulting in a proportional deduction from the employee's casual leave balance, regardless of project tasks finished during those hours.

SECTION 7 – LEAVE POLICY

7.1 Casual Leave (CL) - 8 Days

Casual Leave is provided to handle urgent personal matters, administrative chores, or unforeseen personal requirements. CL must be planned and requested on the HRMS at least forty-eight (48) hours in advance. No more than three (3) consecutive days of CL can be availed in a single instance. CL balances accrue monthly on a pro-rata basis (0.66 days per month).

7.2 Sick Leave (SL) - 8 Days

Sick Leave is designated exclusively for personal medical recoveries, illnesses, or health incidents. For any continuous SL extension exceeding two (2) days, the employee must upload a valid medical certificate issued by a registered medical practitioner onto the HRMS. SL accrues on a pro-rata basis monthly.

7.3 Earned Leave (EL) - 15 Days

Earned Leave (also known as Privilege Leave) is meant for planned vacations, extended family events, or personal rejuvenation. EL applies only upon the successful completion of the standard 6-month probation window. EL requests must be submitted via HRMS at least fifteen (15) days in advance to ensure project delivery continuity. Managers reserve the right to reschedule EL requests if they conflict with critical delivery timelines.

7.4 Maternity Leave

In strict compliance with the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 (and amendments), all eligible female employees are entitled to twenty-six (26) weeks of fully paid Maternity Leave for up to two surviving children. For a female employee having two or more surviving children, the entitlement is restricted to twelve (12) weeks. Medical proof of pregnancy and estimated delivery dates must be submitted to HR at least eight (8) weeks before initiating the leave.

7.5 Paternity Leave

All male employees are eligible for five (5) consecutive working days of paid Paternity Leave to support their spouse post-delivery. This leave must be utilized within three (3) months of the child's birth, failing which it lapses completely. It can be taken in a single installment and requires a birth certificate submission.

7.6 Adoption Leave

Legally compliant paid Adoption Leave of twelve (12) weeks is extended to female employees who legally adopt a child below the age of three (3) months, calculated from the date the child is physically handed over to the adoptive mother. Valid adoption documentation must be filed with HR.

7.7 Bereavement Leave

The company provides five (5) consecutive working days of paid Bereavement Leave in the unfortunate event of the demise of an immediate family member (spouse, children, parents, or siblings). This leave is intended for mourning and funeral arrangements and does not carry over or encash.

7.8 Compensatory Off (Comp-Off)

Employees who physically work a minimum of six (6) active hours on a scheduled weekend or national holiday due to explicit project emergencies are eligible for a Comp-Off. The Comp-Off must be claimed via HRMS within thirty (30) days of the actual weekend work, and it must be utilized within sixty (60) days of approval, after which it automatically expires.

7.9 Leave Without Pay (LWP)

LWP is an extraordinary measure activated only when an employee has completely exhausted all available CL, SL, and EL balances, yet faces prolonged medical emergencies or severe personal situations. LWP requires written approval from the Delivery Head and the CHRO. Unauthorized LWP results in a salary hold and potential disciplinary action.

7.10 Public Holidays

RJ Group publishes a mandatory calendar of ten (10) Public and National Holidays at the start of every calendar year. This list includes mandatory national holidays (Republic Day, Independence Day, Gandhi Jayanti) along with regional festival holidays distributed across regional operating tracks.

Summary of Leave Entitlements

LEAVE TYPE	ANNUAL QUANTUM	ACCRUAL BASIS	MAX CARRY FORWARD (ANNUAL)	ENCASHMENT RULES
Casual Leave (CL)	8 Days	Pro-rata monthly	0 Days (Lapses on Dec 31)	Non-encashable
Sick Leave (SL)	8 Days	Pro-rata monthly	0 Days (Lapses on Dec 31)	Non-encashable
Earned Leave (EL)	15 Days	Credited post-probation	Up to 45 Days maximum	Encashable only at separation
Maternity Leave	26 Weeks	Statutory allocation	Not Applicable	Non-encashable
Paternity Leave	5 Days	On event occurrence	0 Days (Lapses in 3 months)	Non-encashable
Comp-Off	Dynamic	Post weekend approval	0 Days (Lapses in 60 days)	Non-encashable

Example of Leave Misuse Policy Execution: An employee applies for a Sick Leave on Friday and Monday, effectively creating a 4-day weekend. Upon return, the employee fails to provide a medical certificate and is seen checked into a public holiday resort on social media. This is classified as deliberate misrepresentation and leave misuse, triggering a complete conversion of those days into Leave Without Pay (LWP), a deduction of double the days from their remaining CL balance, and a formal written warning added to their permanent HR folder.

SECTION 8 – COMPENSATION AND PAYROLL

8.1 Salary Structure

The compensation architectures at RJ Group are explicitly engineered to remain highly competitive within the Indian IT ecosystem while complying fully with Code on Wages and local statutory dictates. Salaries are broken down into specific components including Basic Salary (mandated at a minimum of 50% of Total Gross CTC), House Rent Allowance (HRA), Leave Travel Allowance (LTA), National Pension Scheme (NPS) provisions, Special Allowances, and Statutory Statutory Bonus lines.

8.2 Payroll Processing

Payroll processing is centrally managed via automated platforms. The calculation loop incorporates real-time inputs from the HRMS attendance logs, approved leave files, dynamic shift allowances, reimbursement logs, and validated tax investment declarations. The payroll cycle closes on the 25th of each calendar month, and any updates received after this date are carried forward to the subsequent month's processing cycle.

8.3 Salary Credit Date

Monthly net salaries are disbursed directly to the employee's designated corporate bank account on the last working day of the calendar month. In the event of catastrophic systemic failure or banking holidays, credits are ensured no later than the 7th day of the succeeding month, in strict adherence to statutory timelines under Indian labor frameworks.

8.4 Deductions

The company executes mandatory and authorized statutory deductions from gross salary before net disbursement. This includes Professional Tax (PT) mapping to state rules, Employee Provident Fund contribution, Employee State Insurance Corporation (ESIC) contributions for eligible brackets, Income Tax deductions (TDS), and any authorized recoveries relating to asset loss or advanced loan clearances.

8.5 Tax Deducted at Source (TDS)

Income Tax deductions are computed automatically based on the employee's selected tax regime (Old vs. New Income Tax Regime). Employees are required to upload their investment declarations and authentic proofs (such as 80C investments, HRA rent receipts, home loan interest certificates) via the HRMS portal by the 15th of January every year. Failure to file valid proofs will result in maximum marginal tax rate deductions during the final quarter of the fiscal year.

8.6 Provident Fund (PF)

RJ Group complies with the Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952. The company matches the statutory contribution of 12% of the basic salary towards the Employee Provident Fund organization account. Employees can opt for basic capping limits or full basic matching based on standard regulatory frameworks and declarations filled during onboarding.

8.7 Gratuity

Gratuity benefits are governed by the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972. Employees are eligible to receive gratuity payouts upon completing a minimum of five (5) years of continuous, uninterrupted service with RJ Group. Gratuity is calculated using the standard formula: $(\text{Last Drawn Basic Salary} + \text{DA}) * 15/26 * \text{Completed Years of Service}$.

8.8 Reimbursements

Reimbursements for legitimate professional expenses—including official client entertainment, approved mobile/broadband connectivity bills, and localized business travel—must be claimed via the HRMS expense module. Claims must be accompanied by original tax invoices/receipts and submitted within thirty (30) days of the expense occurrence. Approved claims are paid out alongside the monthly salary cycle.

8.9 Incentives

Project-linked bonuses, billable utilization incentives, and technical spot awards are disbursed based on specific performance criteria achieved by delivery teams. These incentives require validation from both the Delivery Head and the Finance Controller, and are subject to standard income tax deductions during the credit month.

8.10 Variable Pay

For employees mapped to bands with explicit Variable Pay structures, disbursements are typically managed on a quarterly or annual timeline. Payout percentages are derived from a matrix combining individual performance scores, business unit revenue health, and overall RJ Group corporate profitability metrics.

Sample Executive Salary Component Breakdown Matrix (Gross CTC ₹12,00,000 P.A.)

SALARY COMPONENT	MONTHLY ALLOCATION (₹)	ANNUALIZED ALLOCATION (₹)	NATURE OF COMPONENT / TAX TREATMENT
Basic Salary	50,000	6,00,000	Fully Taxable; Core basis for PF and Gratuity
House Rent Allowance (HRA)	20,000	2,40,000	Exempt up to statutory limits upon rent receipt filing
Special Allowance	21,200	2,54,400	Fully Taxable balancing component
Leave Travel Allowance (LTA)	3,000	36,000	Exempt twice in a block of 4 years for domestic travel
Employer Provident Fund (PF)	5,800	69,600	Statutory Contribution; Tax exempt under 80C choices
Gratuity Provision	2,400	28,800	Retiral Benefit; Accrues towards statutory terminal credit
Total Gross CTC	1,00,000	12,00,000	Comprehensive Cost to Company Baseline

SECTION 9 – EMPLOYEE BENEFITS

9.1 Medical Insurance

RJ Group provides a comprehensive Group Medical Cover (GMC) insurance policy to all permanent employees, fully funded by the company. The standard coverage provides up to ₹5,00,000 per annum for the employee, their legally recognized spouse, and up to two dependent children. The plan includes pre-existing disease coverage, cashless hospitalization across major network hospitals, and day-care treatment coverage. Employees can opt for higher coverage sums or add dependent parents by paying a subsidized premium deducted from their salary.

9.2 Accidental Insurance

To secure families against unforeseen eventualities, all permanent employees are enrolled in the Group Personal Accident (GPA) insurance scheme. This policy offers a 24/7 global coverage envelope equivalent to

three (3) times the employee's annual gross CTC against accidental death, permanent total disability, or temporary partial disability arising from accidents.

9.3 Wellness Benefits

The company promotes a holistic wellness model. Employees have access to free, completely confidential mental health counseling and emotional wellness support through our empaneled Employee Assistance Program (EAP) vendor. Additionally, the company organizes annual health checkups, ergonomic training workshops, and indoor sports tournaments.

9.4 Learning Benefits

To incentivize technical excellence, the company supports professional learning journeys. Employees who complete approved high-end technical certifications (such as AWS Architect, Azure DevOps, GCP, Scrum Master, or Enterprise Security certifications) are eligible for a 100% fee reimbursement, subject to pre-approval from the Learning & Development (L&D) board and successful completion of the certification exam.

9.5 Referral Bonus

The Employee Referral Scheme rewards team members who introduce qualified talent to RJ Group. Bonuses range from ₹15,000 to ₹75,000 depending on the technical band and niche skill requirements of the open role. The referral bonus is paid out in two equal tranches: 50% upon the candidate's successful onboarding, and the remaining 50% after the candidate completes ninety (90) days of active service.

9.6 Recognition Programs

Excellence is recognized through structured monthly, quarterly, and annual award programs. These include "Spot Awards" for outstanding delivery, "Innovator of the Quarter" for architectural breakthroughs, and the prestigious "CEO Circle" annual award for exemplary leadership, which includes cash prizes, plaques, and fast-tracked career progression opportunities.

SECTION 10 – PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

10.1 Goal Setting

The Performance Management System (PMS) operates on an annual cycle with midway reviews. Goal setting is finalized within the first 30 days of the financial year (April). Goals must follow the SMART framework (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound) and are balanced across four dimensions: Delivery Excellence, Technical Upskilling, Process Compliance, and Team Contribution.

10.2 Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

KPIs are highly customized for distinct technical bands. For Software Engineers, standard KPIs track code defect leakage rates (target <5%), on-time sprint ticket delivery (>95%), timesheet compliance, and mandatory code review participation. For Delivery Managers, KPIs center on project gross margin protection, customer satisfaction index (CSAT > 8.5/10), resource utilization rates, and retention within their teams.

10.3 Annual Appraisal Cycle

The annual appraisal window runs from April 1 to May 31. The process requires a comprehensive self-appraisal on the HRMS, followed by a direct manager evaluation, a 360-degree peer feedback cycle, and normalization reviews conducted by the cross-functional Grandfather Review Committee to eliminate rating bias across different business units.

10.4 Rating Scale

RJ Group uses a structured 5-point performance rating system:

- **Rating 5 (Outstanding Performance):** Consistently exceeds all goals; drives high-impact innovations; models core cultural values perfectly.
- **Rating 4 (Exceeds Expectations):** Exceeds key targets regularly; demonstrates deep technical ownership; delivers reliable code without supervision.
- **Rating 3 (Meets Expectations):** Successfully hits target goals; reliable performer; maintains expected delivery quality and compliance standards.
- **Rating 2 (Needs Improvement):** Fails to meet core goals consistently; shows technical or delivery gaps; requires active monitoring and support.
- **Rating 1 (Unsatisfactory Performance):** Continuous performance failures; rejects guidance; displays major compliance gaps or lack of capability.

10.5 Promotions

Promotions are not based on tenure alone; they require a proven ability to perform reliably at the next higher band level. The promotion evaluation window opens annually in June, requiring technical panel validations, a clean disciplinary record, and a minimum rating of "Exceeds Expectations" over the two preceding appraisal cycles.

10.6 Salary Revisions

Salary increments are linked directly to normalized annual appraisal ratings, market inflation adjustments, and internal compensation parity guidelines. Increment letters are issued in June, with payouts backdated to April 1 of the current financial year. Employees currently serving their notice period are ineligible for salary revisions.

10.7 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

Employees who receive a performance rating of "Needs Improvement" (Rating 2) or "Unsatisfactory Performance" (Rating 1), or who experience a sudden drop in delivery quality, may be placed on a structured Performance Improvement Plan (PIP). The PIP lasts for a strict duration of thirty (30) to sixty (60) calendar days. The plan outlines explicit performance gaps, expected weekly milestones, and support metrics provided by the manager. If the employee fails to meet the required performance bar at the conclusion of the PIP, their employment will be terminated immediately due to lack of capability.

Appraisal Normalization and Action Matrix

PERFORMANCE RATING	DISTRIBUTION TARGET	PROPOSED SALARY INCREMENT %	PROMOTION ELIGIBILITY	HR NEXT STEPS / INTERVENTIONS
5 - Outstanding	10%	15% – 25%	High Priority	Enrolment in Leadership Talent Pipeline; Spot Rewards
4 - Exceeds Expectations	25%	10% – 14%	Eligible	Advanced Technical Certifications; Mentorship tracking
3 - Meets Expectations	50%	6% – 9%	Standard Track	Routine skill updates; continued delivery ownership
2 - Needs Improvement	10%	0%	Ineligible	Manager monitoring; Optional 30-day pre-PIP guidance
1 - Unsatisfactory	5%	0%	Ineligible	Mandatory 30/60-Day PIP Initialization; separation risk

SECTION 11 – LEARNING AND DEVELOPMENT (L&D)

11.1 Technical Training

The L&D department runs structured training calendars designed to keep RJ Group's engineering base at the forefront of technological shifts. This includes instructor-led deep dives into advanced full-stack frameworks, microservices design patterns, cloud computing deployment, and secure coding practices. Technical training paths are integrated with project pipeline requirements to ensure rapid, effective team readiness.

11.2 Certifications

The company maintains a curated repository of approved corporate certifications across major platforms (AWS, Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud, Salesforce, Oracle, and Cyber Security boards). As outlined in Section 9, successful certification attempts are fully reimbursed. Employees are expected to complete at least one (1) major certification every eighteen (18) months as part of their professional growth milestones.

11.3 Leadership Development

High-performing employees tracking towards managerial positions are enrolled in the RJ Leadership Academy. This curriculum covers essential management competencies, such as agile project management, contract interpretation, client communication, emotional intelligence, situational leadership, and conflict resolution methodologies, preparing engineers for successful management transitions.

11.4 Education Assistance

Permanent employees who have completed three (3) years of continuous service may apply for the Executive Education Assistance Program. This program provides partial funding support for pursuing approved executive post-graduate degrees, diplomas, or data science programs from accredited institutions, subject to a binding 24-month retention agreement post-graduation.

11.5 Knowledge Sharing (Tech-Talks)

To foster an active culture of continuous peer learning, RJ Group mandates bi-weekly internal knowledge-sharing sessions known as "Tech-Talks". Senior architects, principal engineers, and team members returning from specialized external trainings present technical updates, architectural case studies, and tool optimization insights to the wider engineering community.

SECTION 12 – CODE OF CONDUCT

12.1 Professional Behavior

Employees must maintain high standards of professionalism, integrity, decorum, and mutual respect at all times. This applies to physical offices, client sites, remote work setups, and digital platforms. Professional behavior includes clear, constructive communication, respect for diverse viewpoints, compliance with operational hierarchies, and a commitment to protecting RJ Group's reputation.

12.2 Ethics

RJ Group enforces a zero-tolerance policy for financial fraud, intellectual property theft, falsification of billing/timesheets, bribery, insider trading, or willful misrepresentation of capabilities. Employees must conduct all corporate transactions in strict compliance with legal frameworks and ethical guidelines, ensuring full transparency across all operational records.

12.3 Workplace Respect

The company is committed to providing a workplace free from harassment, discrimination, verbal abuse, or bullying. Any discrimination based on race, caste, color, religion, gender, age, nationality, or physical disability will face severe disciplinary action, including potential termination. Diversity and psychological safety are core priorities for our team.

12.4 Customer Interactions

When interacting with clients, partners, or vendors, employees act as ambassadors for RJ Group. All correspondence, presentations, and status updates must be transparent, professional, timely, and aligned with project SLA commitments. Employees must never disparage competitors or misrepresent project metrics to client teams.

12.5 Social Media Conduct

Employees must not post any text, imagery, or code that discloses confidential RJ Group operations, proprietary technological designs, client identities, or internal project issues on personal social media platforms (such as LinkedIn, X, Facebook, or GitHub). Personal posts must not use the company's brand to support political viewpoints, propagate hate speech, or defame any individual or institution.

12.6 Conflicts of Interest

Employees must avoid any situation where their personal or financial interests conflict with their professional duties at RJ Group. This includes taking outside employment, running a side business, providing freelance

services to competitors, or using company time and resources for personal gain. Any potential conflict of interest must be disclosed to HR using the formal compliance channel.

12.7 Gifts and Hospitality

Employees must not solicit or accept any gifts, cash equivalents, lavish hospitality, or personal favors from current or prospective clients, vendors, or contractors. Modest seasonal gifts or promotional items (such as corporate calendars, diaries, or pens) valued under ₹2,500 may be accepted, provided they are disclosed to and cleared by the compliance officer.

Real-World Conflict of Interest Example: A Senior Tech Lead works on an official RJ Group client account during the day, and provides evening freelance architectural consulting services to a direct competitor of that client. This constitutes a severe conflict of interest and breach of contract. Upon discovery, the employee faces immediate termination for cause, forfeiture of all remaining incentive credits, and potential legal action for breach of confidentiality.

SECTION 13 – INFORMATION SECURITY

13.1 Password Policy

All corporate accounts and access points must be protected by robust passwords. Passwords must be a minimum of twelve (12) characters and include uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and special symbols. Passwords must be changed every forty-five (45) days through the automated access system. Reusing previous passwords is prohibited.

13.2 Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) Requirements

MFA is mandatory across all corporate systems, including emails, HRMS tools, cloud consoles, and source code repositories. Employees must install the authorized authenticator app on their secure corporate devices. Approving prompt requests without initiating a personal login attempt is a serious security breach.

13.3 Device Security

Laptops provided by the company must remain secure at all times. Employees must never turn off corporate antivirus scanners, security tracking software, firewall rules, or automated patch updates. Storing corporate code or client data on unencrypted personal thumb drives, personal cloud backups, or local hard drives is strictly prohibited.

13.4 Acceptable Use

Corporate IT resources must be used exclusively for official business purposes. Employees must not use corporate assets to download pirated software, view inappropriate content, run crypto-mining tasks, or host personal web platforms. The company monitors network logs and device states to ensure compliance.

13.5 Remote Access

When working remotely under the hybrid model, employees must ensure their home Wi-Fi networks are secure and password-protected. Working from unencrypted public Wi-Fi networks (such as those in coffee shops, hotels, or airports) is prohibited unless connected through the official secure VPN gateway.

13.6 VPN Usage

The corporate secure VPN must be active at all times when accessing internal source repositories, testing environments, or client deployment environments. VPN sessions automatically time out after sixty (60) minutes of inactivity, requiring re-authentication to re-establish secure access paths.

13.7 Data Classification

Information assets within RJ Group are mapped into four distinct tiers:

- **Public:** Marketing brochures, public job descriptions, press releases.
- **Internal Use Only:** standard HR forms, operational guides, internal announcements.
- **Confidential:** Financial summaries, project pricing tables, employee salary sheets.
- **Restricted / Secret:** Source code repositories, master client databases, encryption keys.

Access to Restricted assets requires strict role-based authorization from the IT Security Board.

13.8 Security Incidents

Any security incident—including a lost laptop, malware detection, suspected phishing links, or accidental exposure of source code—must be reported to the security operations center (security@rjgroup.com) within two (2) hours of discovery. Fast reporting is vital to minimize system risks.

Security Violation Example: *An engineer pushes a segment of proprietary source code containing active cloud database access keys to a public GitHub repository to work on it over the weekend. This is a severe security infraction that exposes client data. The incident triggers an immediate lockout of all corporate credentials, physical asset recovery, and an inquiry by the Infosec Committee, leading to potential termination for gross negligence.*

SECTION 14 – DATA PRIVACY

14.1 Employee Data

RJ Group respects employee privacy and handles personal data—including residential addresses, bank information, medical records, and performance scores—in compliance with India's Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act. Access to personal employee data is restricted to authorized HR and payroll personnel on a strict need-to-know basis.

14.2 Customer Data

Employees working on client environments must comply with all regional and global data privacy standards, including GDPR, CCPA, and HIPAA, as dictated by the client's operational region. At no point should real Personally Identifiable Information (PII) of customers be downloaded, transferred, or stored outside authorized client environments.

14.3 Data Retention

The company maintains corporate records in accordance with statutory requirements and business requirements. Employee records are preserved for seven (7) years post-separation to meet statutory tax and labor audit requirements, after which they are securely deleted from all digital and physical systems.

14.4 Data Transfers

Any cross-border transfer of technical documentation, personnel summaries, or client metadata must utilize encrypted corporate pathways. These transfers require authorization from the Data Protection Officer (DPO) to ensure compliance with international data transfer frameworks.

14.5 Confidentiality Requirements

All employees are bound by a lifetime Confidentiality Agreement executed at onboarding. This agreement prohibits the unauthorized disclosure of trade secrets, architectural concepts, business strategies, pricing matrices, or project delivery processes during or after their tenure with RJ Group.

SECTION 15 – INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY (IP)

15.1 Ownership

All intellectual property—including source code, architectural designs, technical documentation, testing scripts, algorithms, patches, and business processes created by an employee during their employment with RJ Group—belongs exclusively to the company. This ownership applies whether the work was created during official hours, on personal time, in physical offices, or using remote setups.

15.2 Source Code

Source code created for clients or internal products remains the exclusive property of RJ Group or its clients. Employees are prohibited from copying, adapting, sharing, or removing source code from corporate environments for personal archives or future use outside the company.

15.3 Documentation

Technical manuals, architectural blueprints, user stories, and API definitions developed by employees are protected corporate assets. This documentation must be stored in secure corporate wikis or knowledge platforms, and must not be shared externally without explicit approval from the Delivery Head.

15.4 Patents

If an employee develops a patentable invention or workflow directly related to their work at RJ Group, they must assist the company in securing patent protections. The patent will be registered under RJ Group's ownership, and the company will recognize the contributing employees through its innovation award framework.

15.5 Open Source Software (OSS) Usage

Incorporating open-source software libraries into client deliverables or internal products must comply with the company's Open Source Policy. Employees must not use components governed by restrictive copyleft licenses (such as GNU GPL) that could compromise corporate or client intellectual property. All open-source components must be cleared through automated vulnerability scanners.

SECTION 16 – POSH POLICY (INDIA)

16.1 Objective & Policy Statement

RJ Group is committed to providing a safe, secure, and professional working environment free from sexual harassment, exploitation, or intimidation. In accordance with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 ("POSH Act"), the company enforces a zero-tolerance policy against any conduct that violates the dignity of women at the workplace.

16.2 Definitions

Under the POSH Act, "sexual harassment" includes any one or more of the following unwelcome acts or behavior (whether directly or by implication):

- Physical contact and advances.
- A demand or request for sexual favors.
- Making sexually colored remarks.
- Showing pornography or inappropriate visual content.
- Any other unwelcome physical, verbal, or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature.

Additionally, "Workplace" extends beyond physical offices to include client sites, vendor facilities, work-related travel, company transportation, team dinners, and digital workspaces or communication platforms utilized under the hybrid model.

16.3 Examples of Prohibited Conduct

- Implied or explicit promises of preferential treatment in employment in exchange for sexual favors (Quid Pro Quo).
- Implied or explicit threats of detrimental treatment or termination if sexual advances are rejected.
- Creating a hostile, intimidating, or offensive working environment through inappropriate comments, jokes, or digital messages.
- Inappropriate comments regarding an individual's physical appearance, lifestyle choices, or personal relationships.

16.4 Internal Committee (IC) Structure

RJ Group has established a dedicated Internal Committee (IC) across its regional offices to handle all POSH complaints. The committee is formed in compliance with statutory regulations and consists of:

- **Presiding Officer:** A senior female employee chosen from the management band.

- **Employee Members:** At least two (2) employees committed to the cause of women's rights or possessing relevant legal or human resources experience.
- **External Member:** An independent individual from a non-governmental organization (NGO) or association familiar with issues relating to sexual harassment and legal frameworks.

At least 50% of the total IC membership must be female. The committee's contact details are updated on the HRMS dashboard and physical office notice boards.

16.5 Complaint Process

Any aggrieved woman may file a formal written complaint of sexual harassment with the IC within three (3) months from the date of the incident (or the last incident in a series). The complaint should be submitted via email (posh@rjgroup.com) or in a sealed envelope delivered directly to the Presiding Officer. The complaint must include specific dates, times, descriptions of the events, and names of any witnesses or supporting evidence.

16.6 Conciliation

Before initiating a formal inquiry, the IC may, at the written request of the aggrieved woman, take steps to settle the matter through conciliation, provided that no monetary settlement forms the basis of this conciliation. If a settlement is reached, the IC will record the terms and forward them to the Management for implementation, and provide copies to both parties. No further inquiry will be conducted unless a party fails to comply with the settlement terms.

16.7 Inquiry & Investigation Process

If conciliation is not requested or fails, the IC will launch a formal inquiry. A copy of the complaint is shared with the respondent within seven (7) working days, allowing them ten (10) working days to file a formal response with supporting evidence. Both parties are given equal opportunities to present their case, examine witnesses, and provide evidence. The inquiry must follow principles of natural justice, and both parties are prohibited from bringing legal practitioners to represent them during the proceedings.

16.8 Timelines for Redressal

PROCEDURAL STEP	STATUTORY TIMELINE LIMIT
FILING OF FORMAL COMPLAINT	Within 3 months of the date of the incident
FORWARDING COMPLAINT COPY TO RESPONDENT	Within 7 working days from receipt of complaint
RESPONDENT'S RESPONSE SUBMISSION	Within 10 working days from receipt of complaint copy
COMPLETION OF ENTIRE FORMAL INQUIRY	Within 90 days from initiation
SUBMISSION OF FINAL INQUIRY REPORT TO MANAGEMENT	Within 10 days from completion of inquiry
IMPLEMENTATION OF RECOMMENDATIONS BY MANAGEMENT	Within 60 days from receipt of final report

16.9 Corrective Actions & Sanctions

If the IC concludes that the allegation against the respondent is substantiated, it will recommend specific disciplinary actions to Management. Actions may include a formal written apology, a mandatory warning letter added to the employee's file, suspension, withholding of promotions/increments, termination for cause, or the deduction of financial compensation from the respondent's salary to be paid to the complainant. If the conduct constitutes a violation under the Indian Penal Code, the company will support the complainant in pursuing legal remedies.

16.10 Protection Against Retaliation & Malicious Intent

The company enforces strict protections against retaliation or victimization of the complainant or any witnesses involved in an inquiry. Any attempt at retaliation will be treated as major misconduct subject to immediate termination. Conversely, if the IC concludes that a complaint was intentionally false or malicious, the complainant will face similar disciplinary actions under major misconduct rules.

SECTION 17 – WHISTLEBLOWER POLICY

17.1 Reporting Channels

The Whistleblower Policy provides a secure channel for employees to report concerns regarding unethical behavior, financial fraud, regulatory non-compliance, environmental hazards, or danger to company health

and safety. Reports can be submitted via the dedicated email hotline (whistleblower@rjgroup.com) or mailed to the Head of Corporate Governance and Compliance.

17.2 Anonymous Reporting

Employees can submit reports anonymously if they choose. To facilitate a thorough investigation, anonymous reports should include detailed, objective evidence, such as specific dates, document names, and clear records of the alleged misconduct. The company will evaluate anonymous submissions based on the specificity and severity of the information provided.

17.3 Investigation Process

All whistleblower reports are routed to the Audit Committee. An initial assessment is conducted within five (5) business days to determine if a formal investigation is warranted. If approved, an independent review panel is formed to examine witnesses, audit electronic logs, and collect evidence. The investigation report is reviewed by executive leadership for corrective action.

17.4 Protection Against Retaliation

RJ Group enforces strict protections for whistleblowers who report concerns in good faith. The company prohibits retaliation, discrimination, or career penalties against any employee who submits a report or participates in an investigation. Any employee found engaging in retaliatory behavior will face severe disciplinary action, including potential termination.

SECTION 18 – TRAVEL AND EXPENSE POLICY

18.1 Domestic Travel

The Travel and Expense Policy outlines guidelines and reimbursement rules for official business travel within India. All business travel must receive prior written approval from the business unit head via the HRMS Travel Module before bookings are finalized by the corporate travel desk.

18.2 Air Travel Eligibility

Employees mapped to Management and Delivery Head bands are eligible for economy class air travel for official trips exceeding 300 kilometers. Employees in engineering bands are eligible for economy air travel for long-distance trips, or AC II-Tier rail travel for overnight regional journeys, subject to project budget clearances.

18.3 Hotel Accommodation Eligibility

The company maintains partnerships with preferred hotel networks across tier-1 and tier-2 cities. Standard accommodations are restricted to 3-star corporate hotels for engineering teams and 4-star properties for delivery heads and executives. Room service charges, laundry, and personal mini-bar use are not covered by the company.

18.4 Meal Limits

Employees on official travel status can claim a Daily Allowance (DA) or actual out-of-pocket meal expenses up to specified limits: Tier-1 Cities (Mumbai, Delhi-NCR, Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad) are capped at ₹1,500 per day; Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities are capped at ₹1,000 per day. Itemized food bills are required for reimbursement.

18.5 Local Transportation

For airport transfers and client visits during travel, employees should utilize corporate cab networks or app-based ridesharing services (such as Uber or Ola). Claims for local travel reimbursements must include digital trip receipts and a clear description of the business purpose.

18.6 Reimbursement Workflow

Travel expense reports must be submitted through the HRMS platform within ten (10) working days of returning from a trip. Claims must include all original tax invoices, boarding passes, and booking receipts. Approved claims are processed by finance and disbursed during the next monthly payroll cycle.

Travel Class and Expense Entitlement Grid

EMPLOYEE BAND LEVEL	AIR / RAIL TRAVEL CLASS	HOTEL CATEGORY ENTITLEMENT	DAILY MEAL LIMIT (TIER-1)	DAILY MEAL LIMIT (TIER-2)
BAND E1 – E3 (ENGINEERS)	Rail AC II-Tier / Economy Air (long distance)	Standard 3-Star Corporate Hotel	₹1,200 / day	₹800 / day
BAND M1 – M3 (MANAGERS)	Economy Class Air Travel Always	Premium 3-Star or 4-Star Corporate Hotel	₹1,500 / day	₹1,000 / day
BAND CXO / VP (EXECUTIVE)	Economy Class Air / Business Class (International)	5-Star Luxury Business Hotel	Actuals based on receipts	Actuals based on receipts

SECTION 19 – HEALTH AND SAFETY

19.1 Workplace Safety

RJ Group is dedicated to providing a safe, secure, and physically healthy environment across all its office premises. Physical facilities feature 24/7 security presence, electronic access controls, active CCTV networks, clear lighting, and regular sanitization cycles. All safety policies comply with local shops and establishments act rules.

19.2 Emergency Procedures

All facilities are equipped with integrated fire detection alarms, visible fire extinguishers, and clearly marked emergency exit stairwells. The company runs mandatory fire drills every six months in coordination with facility management. In the event of an emergency evacuation, employees must follow the guidance of designated floor wardens.

19.3 Ergonomics

To reduce workplace strain and promote health, office facilities are equipped with adjustable ergonomic chairs and spacious workstations. Employees are encouraged to adjust monitor heights, utilize task lighting, and take brief periodic breaks during extended coding or design sessions.

19.4 Hybrid Workplace Safety

When working remotely under the hybrid framework, employees are responsible for ensuring their home workspace is safe, well-ventilated, and free from electrical or physical hazards. The company provides online ergonomic assessments to help employees configure their home workspaces safely.

SECTION 20 – DISCIPLINARY POLICY

20.1 Minor Misconduct

Minor misconduct includes minor infractions that disrupt daily office operations but do not cause material financial or legal damage. Examples include occasional unexcused lateness, failure to update timesheets, minor dress code infractions, or mild discourtesy toward peers. Minor infractions are addressed through verbal warnings and documented feedback.

20.2 Major Misconduct

Major misconduct involves severe actions that compromise company integrity, cause material damage, or violate legal regulations. Examples include theft, financial fraud, physical violence, data leaks, intellectual property theft, willful insubordination, POSH violations, or continuous unexcused absences. Major misconduct results in immediate suspension pending an inquiry.

20.3 Investigation Process

Upon receiving a report of major misconduct, HR will form a Disciplinary Inquiry Committee within three (3) business days. The employee is issued a formal Show-Cause Notice outlining the allegations and is given forty-eight (48) hours to respond. The committee reviews all digital logs, witness accounts, and physical records before making a recommendation.

20.4 Warning Process

For repeated minor misconduct or secondary infractions, the company issues formal Written Warnings. A Written Warning outlines the nature of the issue, required behavioral changes, and a specific monitoring timeframe. Receiving three (3) written warnings within a twelve-month period will trigger immediate termination for cause.

20.5 Suspension

The company may place an employee under suspension during an ongoing disciplinary investigation into major misconduct. Suspension helps ensure an objective investigation and protects company assets. Suspensions may be paid or unpaid depending on the nature and severity of the allegations, as determined by HR and Legal.

20.6 Termination

Termination for cause occurs when an employee is found guilty of gross misconduct, material contract breaches, or criminal activity. Termination for cause takes effect immediately upon the issuance of the termination letter. All outstanding variable pay and incentives are forfeited, and the company reserves the right to pursue legal remedies.

Disciplinary Action Progressive Matrix

INFRACTION CLASSIFICATION	FIRST OCCURRENCE ACTION	SECOND OCCURRENCE ACTION	THIRD OCCURRENCE ACTION
MINOR MISCONDUCT (TARDINESS/TIMESHEETS)	Documented Verbal Warning by Manager	First Official Written Warning from HR	Final Written Warning; suspension of hybrid privileges
REPEAT MINOR MISCONDUCT (INSUBORDINATION)	First Official Written Warning from HR	Final Written Warning; Performance Rating freeze	Termination of Employment for Cause
MAJOR MISCONDUCT (FRAUD/DATA THEFT/POSH)	Immediate Suspension; Formal Inquiry initialization	Termination of Employment for Cause upon verification	Not Applicable

SECTION 21 – GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL

21.1 Reporting Concerns

RJ Group is committed to addressing employee concerns regarding working conditions, manager decisions, payroll errors, or peer conflicts promptly and fairly. Employees should first raise grievances informally with their direct manager or assigned HR Business Partner (HRBP).

21.2 Escalation Matrix

If an informal resolution is not reached within five (5) working days, the employee can escalate the grievance through the formal HRMS Grievance Module. The escalation path runs from the Employee to the Functional HR Head, then to the Grievance Redressal Committee, and finally to the Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) for a final determination.

21.3 Investigation Process

The Grievance Redressal Committee reviews escalated complaints by gathering facts, interviewing relevant parties, and reviewing documented communications. The process is conducted confidentially and impartially, ensuring all participants are treated with respect and given an opportunity to present their perspectives.

21.4 Resolution Timelines

The company targets a standard resolution timeframe of fifteen (15) working days from the formal filing of a grievance. If an extension is required due to the complexity of the case, the employee will receive a written update explaining the reasons for the delay and an adjusted target closure date.

SECTION 22 – SEPARATION POLICY

22.1 Resignation

Employees wishing to resign from their positions must submit a formal resignation request to their direct manager and HR through the HRMS Portal. The resignation request must clearly state the proposed last working day, keeping in mind contractual notice obligations.

22.2 Notice Period (60 Days)

In accordance with the employment agreement, all permanent employees are required to serve a mandatory notice period of sixty (60) calendar days from the date of their formal resignation submission. The notice period allows for proper project transitions and knowledge transfers. Leaves applied during the notice period require explicit approval from the Delivery Head and will extend the last working day by an equivalent number of days.

22.3 Notice Buyout Guidelines

In exceptional circumstances, and at the sole discretion of the Delivery Head and HR, the company may consider a notice buyout request. A buyout allows the employee to shorten their notice period by paying the company an amount equal to their gross salary for the remaining undelivered days. Buyouts are subject to project demands and require a finalized transition plan.

22.4 Exit Interview

During the final week of employment, HR schedules a formal exit interview. This session provides an opportunity for departing employees to share candid feedback regarding their experience at RJ Group, management practices, training efficacy, and reasons for separation, helping the company identify areas for continuous improvement.

22.5 Knowledge Transfer (KT)

Departing employees must execute a comprehensive Knowledge Transfer (KT) process. The employee must document all ongoing architectural tasks, provide up-to-date code check-ins, transition system credentials to

an assigned peer, and conduct walkthrough sessions. The KT progress must be logged and approved weekly by the Project Manager via the Exit Clearance Tracker.

22.6 Asset Return

On or before their last working day, the employee must return all assigned company assets—including laptops, power cords, security tokens, monitors, and identification cards—to the IT infrastructure desk. Assets must be in good condition, accounting for reasonable wear and tear. Any missing or unreturned assets will result in financial recoveries deducted from the final settlement.

SECTION 23 – FULL AND FINAL SETTLEMENT (FnF)

23.1 Settlement Process

The Full and Final (FnF) settlement process is completed within thirty (30) days from the employee's official last working day. The finance team consolidates all outstanding salary credits, accrued earned leave encashments, reimbursement balances, and any applicable statutory gratuity credits to determine the final net payout.

23.2 Recoveries

Any outstanding financial liabilities—including notice buyout shortfalls, unreturned asset costs, unapproved travel advances, or excess leaves utilized beyond pro-rata balances—will be deducted from the employee's gross settlement value during the FnF calculation process.

23.3 Relieving Letter

A formal Relieving Letter confirming the successful completion of service and the official date of separation is issued electronically via the HRMS portal within five (5) working days after the final clear closure of the FnF settlement process. This document is provided only after all departmental clearances are complete.

23.4 Experience Letter

The Experience Letter is issued alongside the relieving documentation. It outlines the employee's total tenure, final designation, and core areas of functional responsibility within RJ Group, serving as an official statement of service for future professional opportunities.

SECTION 24 – APPENDICES

Appendix A – Leave Matrix Summary

CATEGORY	DAYS P.A.	APPROVAL ADVANCE NOTICE	MAX CARRY FORWARD	KEY RULE
Casual Leave	8 Days	48 Hours	0 Days	Max 3 days per instance
Sick Leave	8 Days	Same Day (by 10 AM)	0 Days	Medical certificate required for >2 days
Earned Leave	15 Days	15 Days	45 Days	Eligible only post-probation

Appendix B – Corporate Escalation Matrix

GRIEVANCE TYPE	LEVEL 1 RESPONSE NODE	LEVEL 2 ESCALATION NODE	FINAL ARBITER NODE
PROJECT & DELIVERY ISSUES	Project Manager	Delivery Head	Chief Operating Officer (COO)
PAYROLL, TAXES & CTC	Payroll Executive	Finance Controller	Chief Financial Officer (CFO)
HARASSMENT / CODE OF CONDUCT	HR Business Partner	Grievance Committee	Chief HR Officer (CHRO) / IC Presiding Officer

Appendix C – Employee Declaration & Acknowledgement

I hereby acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the RJ Group Human Resources Policy Manual (Version 1.0). I agree to comply with all the policies, rules, security mandates, and behavioral guidelines outlined in this manual throughout my tenure with the company. I understand that compliance is a condition of my employment, and that any violation may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of service.

Employee Name: _____

Employee ID: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____